

UNDONE

"The Party"

Written by Kai Paynter and Ella Sullivan

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Please Note:

// indicates overlapping text.

No formal punctuation is interpreted as production's discretion.

1. INT. NATHANS HOUSE PARTY. NIGHT

KEHLANI (25, wearing high boots, skirt and a leather jacket) and JAKE (25, wearing a fitted white t-shirt, trucker hat, boots and jeans) catch a glimpse of each other. Jake cannot look away. Randoms engage her and leave. Jake watches intently. He is seated next to his cousin but they look out of place. Finally, after a while of this intensity, Kehlani signals to Jake. She steps out, he follows.

CUT TO:

2. EXT. STREET. NIGHT.

KEHLANI

Hi

She's hunting

JAKE

Hi

He grins wide. Long stare, long silence.

KEHLANI

Not much of a talker?

Jake starts mumbling. Kehlani hears that drawl. Impressed, she interrupts.

KEHLANI (CONT'D)

Were you just gonna stare at me the whole night, like some predator?

JAKE

Oh my god, no no no, I was just lookin-

KEHLANI

Right, No intention of buying though.

JAKE

Like a date? Are you asking me out?

KEHLANI

I am definitely not asking you out

JAKE

Hahaha...(He catches himself)
Hahaha. I assumed you were with Nathan.

KEHLANI

Huh. What gave you that impression?

JAKE

Something tells me he can afford you...

KEHLANI

What. Wow.

JAKE

No, it looks like you've got expensive taste and he seems to be doing... (he gestures to the house) pretty well.

KEHLANI

Who said I need a man to "buy me"//
What in the 1940s shit are you-

JAKE

// No, I, I. (Takes a moment.) I just mean you could get anyone- I don't know what I'm saying. I'm acting weird. I'm Jake. I'll go back inside now.

Jake starts to turn awkwardly.

KEHLANI

Ok. Ok. Lets start over. Hi, I'm Kehlani. I saw you looking at me.

JAKE

I saw you looking at me, too Kehlani. What kinda name is Kehlani?

KEHLANI

It's Hawaiian

JAKE

You're Hawaiian?

KEHLANI

Do I look Hawaiian?

JAKE

Indian?

She's not impressed.

JAKE (CONT'D)
Puerto Rican... African?

KEHLANI
I'm American, (Mouths) What the
fuck...

JAKE
I'm really bad at this. You're
pretty, that's all I know...

She infers

KEHLANI
You've never been with a Black
girl...

JAKE
No. (Perplexed) You're Black?

KEHLANI
Well I'm not gonna get you up to
speed. It's been nice chatting but
I'm not a token.

It stings for them both but more for Jake.

JAKE
Woah, it's not like that. I'm not
into politics.

Completely goes over his head.

KEHLANI
Okay. Let's stop before we get into
all that because now you sound
stupid. Everyone's into politics.
You can't not be into politics-

JAKE
Oh yeah?

KEHLANI
Fact

JAKE
Well I'm not into politics but I'm
into you... Is that ok?

KEHLANI
Not unless you're gonna do
something about it?

JAKE
Which part?

Kehlani now very annoyed. Turns her back on him and starts looking for her phone.

JAKE (CONT'D)
Hey, can we start over? My name's
Jake.

Kehlani with a quick turn.

KEHLANI
Jake what?

JAKE
Jake Kozlowicz.

KEHLANI
Very Polish

JAKE
I'm very American... like you.

KEHLANI
Funny.

They stare for a few seconds, curious.

KEHLANI (CONT'D)
Wanna get out of here?

JAKE
Yes. Anywhere with you

Kehlani smiles. They talk, walk- laughing and jokingly bump into one another. The impression of time passes.

CUT TO:

Jake picks Kehlani up and carries her on his shoulder, she squeals, jokingly hitting his back. She's carrying a McDonald's to-go bag

KEHLANI
Put me down! Put me down.. Jake, oh
my god, I'm wearing a skirt!

JAKE
You said your feet were hurting,
I'm helping you out!

KEHLANI
That's not what I meant! Put me
down. Jake!

Jake puts her down gently, drawing her in closer to him. They
kiss. It's new, a little awkward. Jake reaches his hand down
her thigh and draws it up slowly, she catches his hand before
he gets too far. He pulls back.

JAKE
You good?

KEHLANI
Yeah, sobering up...

JAKE
Better get another one in ya, huh?

KEHLANI
What? You like me better tipsy or
something?

JAKE
Well I've only known you drunk so
far, and so far you're pretty cool...

KEHLANI
There's a liquor store on the next
corner, you wanna get some more to
drink?

JAKE
Sure

The pair walk a little further to the liquor store, hand in
hand, a little sloppy. Kehlani pauses.

KEHLANI
Wait

She takes off her boots

JAKE
What are you doing?

KEHLANI
They just hurt so much!

JAKE
You're not worried you'll step on
something?

KEHLANI
We're almost there.

JAKE

Okay... be careful though. These city streets are crazy. "Hot Girl Steps on Syringe, Now Addicted to Heroin". Date gone wrong.

KEHLANI

There's no heroine around here, Country Boy...And, what makes you think this is a date?

JAKE

I mean... two people leave a boring party to go grab dinner and a drink. Girl invites guy back to her place... If the shoe fits...

He shrugs

KEHLANI

Ummm... were we at the same party? It was lit. The vibes were on point-

JAKE

You were lit... still sounds like a date to me

Kehlani rolls her eyes, laughing.

KEHLANI

Shut up.

They stop at the liquor store. Going inside, Kehlani stops just shy of the entrance, remembering something.

KEHLANI (CONT'D)

I gotta take a quick call. Can you get me a Rosé?

She searches for her wallet

JAKE

Fancy lady.

KEHLANI

9 dollar wine. Yeah, I'm real sophisticated.

She pulls out her phone and hands him her credit card.

JAKE

I got it.

KEHLANI
Its 9 bucks, I got it

JAKE
Nah, its fine.

Kehlani frowns

KEHLANI
I think I can manage 9 dollars

JAKE
Will you let me be a gentleman?

Kehlani relents. He goes inside. Kehlani texts someone and scrolls a little, then watches him intently. She observes his every move and they make eye contact as Jake opens the door. He smiles.

KEHLANI
This still isn't a date // Thankyou

JAKE
//Guy pays for a bottle of wine,
dinner, I don't know...This is
feeling more and more like a
date...

Kehlani just looks at him. They start walking.

JAKE (CONT'D)
I'm joking, not a date. I know, I
just wanna say... thanks. For hanging
out with me. And getting me out of
that retirement village of a party.

KEHLANI
My god, it was not that boring.

JAKE
I knew it was a bust when they
brought out the charcuterie board.

Kehlani with an insanely hearty laugh.

KEHLANI
Okay, that's true. How do you know
Nathan, by the way?

JAKE
Friend of my cousins. I'd never met
him before tonight, don't really
know anything about him to be
honest.

(MORE)

JAKE (CONT'D)

Thought he'd be a bit more fun than that though, he's from LA and everything. You?

She's kurt

KEHLANI

Yeah, I work with him. (She pauses.) I'm glad we left.

JAKE

Huh... me, too... me, too

Kehlani smiles, she holds up the wine.

KEHLANI

Come on! My place is just a few streets away.

They keep walking along the street, hands bushing one another's, Kehlani takes his hand in hers, together, they run the last few blocks, laughing, stumbling, hanging off one another. Excited by each-other.

CUT TO:

3. INT. KEHLANI'S APPARTMENT. NIGHT

Kehlani and Jake walk into the apartment. Kehlani chucks her shoes by the door and slides on a pair of slippers. Jake looks at her and awkwardly takes off his shoes before walking into the room, looking around. A double bed decorated with pillows takes up most of the room, a bedside table next to it. There's a table at the end of the bed with a notebook, an easel, paint brushes, water colors, and a laptop resting on it, presumably where she does her work. Opposite the table, on the wall is a TV.

JAKE

So... this is your place?

KEHLANI

Uh-huh

JAKE

Hmm

KEHLANI

What?

JAKE

What?

KEHLANI

Why are you making that face?

JAKE

I'm not making any-

KEHLANI

Yes you are. You're doing it right now...

JAKE

This is just my face!

KEHLANI

You're soooo judging my apartment right now!

JAKE

I'm not! It's cute!

KEHLANI

Rich coming from someone who's choosing to live in a motel for a month.

JAKE

I'm budgeting so I can buy cute girls dinner, can you blame me?

KEHLANI

I never asked you to pay

JAKE

I know, I wanted to, I'm joking-

KEHLANI

I-

JAKE

I know-

KEHLANI

It feels like you're holding it over me, like tryna make me feel bad or something.

JAKE

Okay, I'll stop mentioning it. Sorry.

Kehlani puts the wine down on the table, shaking off the moment.

JAKE (CONT'D)
I'm just saying your place is nice...
A lot nicer than the motel, that's
all I wanted to say.

Kehlani nods her head in silence, staring.

JAKE (CONT'D)
Your bed looks pretty comfortable
too...

Jake walks over to the bed and sits down not without his
classic smile.

KEHLANI
You think you're staying the night?

JAKE
I just thought uh... I mean- you
asked me-

KEHLANI
Oh, you thought you were spending
the night? Cute.

JAKE
I just thought since- you know-

KEHLANI
No, I don't.

Kehlani and Jake stare at each other, Jake confused.

KEHLANI (CONT'D)
I'm just kidding! Oh my god, relax!
Way too easy to get you going.

JAKE
And you enjoy that?

KEHLANI
Ummm...maybe. I find it kinda fun...
yeah.

JAKE
You're evil. You're actually evil.

Kehlani laughs, moving closer to Jake. They sit down on the
edge of her bed, their faces close. Jake puts his hand on the
back of Kehlani's neck, attempting to pull her in closer. She
suddenly pulls back. A glimmer of fear in her eye. She
quickly recovers and stands, hoping Jake doesn't question her
reaction.

KEHLANI
I need another drink. Wine?

JAKE
Yeah, I'd love some

KEHLANI
I'll grab some glasses. Be right back.

Kehlani turns to leave, before stopping at the door and turning back

KEHLANI (CONT'D)
Don't go through my shit while I'm gone, yeah?

Jake grins

JAKE
Wouldn't dream of it

KEHLANI
I mean it, ok? If I come back here and see you anywhere in the room but right there, "You're outta here!" Kicking you to the curb.

Jake holds up his hands in mock surrender.

JAKE
You got it

KEHLANI
I'm serious, I'm so serious, brother.

JAKE
So am I

Kehlani gives him a final look and leaves through the kitchen door, popping back in one more time to make sure Jake hasn't moved, she's half joking, half serious. Jake just grins at her. She goes to the kitchen. Jake sits on the bed. Tapping his hands on his thighs, he sees a notebook on the table, he reaches for it, holding it gently in his hands. He goes to open it but hears Kehlani approaching, he quickly replaces it.

JAKE (CONT'D)
Okay... I know you said not to go through your shit but...

Kehlani stares at him, incredulous.

JAKE (CONT'D)

I opened the top drawer. Sex toys?
You? Really? That many- gheeesh!

Kehlani relents, rolling her eyes.

KEHLANI

You're seriously not that funny.

She finds him that funny.

JAKE

Not in the slightest? I think I
have a great sense of humor. Lots
of people tell me I'm funny.

KEHLANI

Who? Your mother?

JAKE

You're funny

Kehlani makes a questioning noise at him "Ooooo", pouring
wine into two glasses and handing one to Jake. They each take
a sip.

JAKE (CONT'D)

This is... surprisingly good.

KEHLANI

What can I say, I've got good
taste.

JAKE

Thats why I'm here, right? Your
Good taste.

Jake gestures to himself. Kehlani laughs, shaking her head.

KEHLANI

My good taste tends to be less
reliable when I drink. Don't
flatter yourself too much.

JAKE

Ouch

KEHLANI

But... Intoxicated Me thinks you're
cute.

JAKE

Oh, does she now?

KEHLANI

She does

JAKE

What else does she think about me?

KEHLANI

Mmmm. You've got a... You can tell you're not from here. I like that. I like that you're... clueless. I think it's cute that you know basically nothing about the city. You're like... a little baby.

JAKE

A baby (he laughs) What the hell?

KEHLANI

Well you are! You've never left your home town till now! Where did you say you were from again? Indiana, right? A farm?

JAKE

Cattle, yeah.

KEHLANI

See, that's so cute. Small town boy, out in the big city. Has to find a local girl to show him the scary world.

JAKE

You think you're saving me?

KEHLANI

Oh I know I am

Jake postures himself as a damsel in distress.

KEHLANI (CONT'D)

Shut the fuck up

JAKE

Ok.

Kehlani leans in and kisses him. She has a sudden thought, pulling away, she sips on her wine.

KEHLANI

And... You're here for- how long did you say?

JAKE

A couple months- for now, hopefully longer...

He grins

JAKE (CONT'D)

Depending on if I get work or not

KEHLANI

And if you don't get work?

Jake shrugs

JAKE

Back to Indiana, I guess. Work the farm with Dad, like always... But I'm excited to be in LA. I'm gonna be a musician, you know. Well... trying to be. I don't think I'd be happy back home unless I gave it a real shot. And, I've got a good demo behind me, I think- I just need to get it out there.

KEHLANI

You sing?

JAKE

I guess you could say that. I learned guitar first. I don't know... it's the only thing that's ever made sense. I started writing songs when I was just a kid, wasn't much of a talker-

KEHLANI

Whaaaaaat?

JAKE

Yeah well, little Jakey was shy. I started writing songs, eventually singing. And, its all I've ever really wanted to do. Dad says it's a dead end ... I'm meant to take over the farm once he retires. Work there. But... I just know that's not for me.

Kehlani nods

JAKE (CONT'D)

Sorry. This is boring

KEHLANI

No, I like hearing about your life.

JAKE

I thought you'd have had enough talking after dinner.

KEHLANI

Are you saying I talk too much?

JAKE

No. I'm saying I do... But maybe we should just... not say anything for a while hmmm? See how that goes.

He smiles. Kehlani roars

JAKE (CONT'D)

You just like making fun of me, don't you?

Kehlani Laughs

JAKE (CONT'D)

Anyway, I think it's your turn to tell me something, isn't it? You've barely told me anything, besides your name

KEHLANI

And I'd like it to stay that way. Keep a lil bit of mystery.

She sips her wine

KEHLANI (CONT'D)

Besides, I like hearing you talk. Like... I like the way you phrase things and shit.

Jake looks at her, a smile creeping onto his face.

KEHLANI (CONT'D)

What? What are you thinking?

JAKE

I'm just thinking

KEHLANI

Thinking about what? Tell me!

She laughs

JAKE
I'm just thinking 'bout what they
say about LA.

KEHLANI
What'd they say?

JAKE
About how its the city of dreams

KEHLANI
Not a bonafide lover boy!

JAKE
I'm serious! This place must be
magic or something. I've been here
less than 24 hours and I've already
met the nicest, hottest girl in the
city. What are the chances?

KEHLANI
I'm the hottest girl in LA? Take it
easy.

JAKE
So, where do all the models hang
out?

She shrugs

KEHLANI
Iono

JAKE
Come onnnn, you're telling me
you're not a model?

Kehlani laughs

KEHLANI
Alright, Slick-Rick..

JAKE
Seriously? With legs like that-

KEHLANI
I'm 5'3". Don't play with me

He shrugs

JAKE
So... not a model then... actress?

Kehlani shakes her head

JAKE (CONT'D)

Writer

KEHLANI

Guess again

JAKE

Hmmmmmm.... Um... pornstar?

KEHLANI

Seriously?

JAKE

Hey I mean, all those vibrators I found when I was going through your stuff. It'd make sense.

She cringes, but likes the flirting.

KEHLANI

I'm a painter but I work as a part-time museum cleaner.

JAKE

A cleaner?

KEHLANI

What's wrong with that? I'm not defined by what I do, I'm defined by what I am, by what I say I am.
// And a job doesn't-

JAKE

// I just meant you don't look like someone who should get down and dirty. That's real cool, though.

KEHLANI

Kinda. I mainly just polish metal objects, railings, shrines, shit like that. I wouldn't say I'm getting dirty. There's a janitor who cleans the bathrooms and stuff. That I couldn't do... well, maybe. If I needed to.

JAKE

How long have you been doing that?

KEHLANI

Ahhhhh, I've been selling my artwork on Instagram for five years now. I've had the cleaning gig for two.

(MORE)

KEHLANI (CONT'D)

Before that I worked as a preschool teacher but I didn't have time to focus on my art, doing that.

JAKE

Ahh

KEHLANI

Yeah

Jake is blank. This is very new to him.

KEHLANI (CONT'D)

I work mostly with water colors.

JAKE

Oh, so like girlie shit

KEHLANI

I mean... no? Well, I guess a lot of women buy my work but...

JAKE

Yeah... so, like, girlie shit.

KEHLANI

Not really, guys also-

Jake shifts gears

JAKE

So-

KEHLANI

Don't do that.

JAKE

Huh?

KEHLANI

I was just making a point and you cut me off.

JAKE

No I didn't-

KEHLANI

Yes you did! I was answering your question about my job and you just cut me off.

JAKE

No, we were done talking about it-

KEHLANI

You were done talking about it. You were done talking about it when you found out I wasn't a model or a pornstar, which, by the way, kind of a fucked up thing to say to me. You're lucky I'm cool.

JAKE

You're offended?

KEHLANI

No, I said you're lucky I'm not. Most girls would be.

JAKE

What, by being told they're attractive?

KEHLANI

No. By being told they're a pornstar.

He's embarrassed

JAKE

I was giving you a compliment, it was a bad joke. I was joking.

KEHLANI

No, you weren't. If I'd said "Yeah, I'm a pornstar", You'd have been so fucking excited.

JAKE

Yeah, I'd have been pretty excited. But that doesn't mean anything, I'm just as excited that you're a painter.

KEHLANI

Uh-huh

JAKE

What?

They sip their wine

KEHLANI

And what makes you think I just invited you back here to have sex?

JAKE

I never said-

KEHLANI

You implied it. All you've done all night is hint at how much you wanna fuck me.

JAKE

Well...

Jake is flustered

JAKE (CONT'D)

I do. I thought that was kinda obvious. I'm just being honest // I mean, what are we doin' here-

KEHLANI

// It is. So you came back to mine, to fuck me?

JAKE

...Is that not why you bought me back here?

KEHLANI

I invited you back here cause I was having a good time getting to know you.//

JAKE

// I am, too! You're nice, you're funny- //

KEHLANI

// But the constant... I don't know, signaling that I'm obligated to fuck you. "Oh I'll pay for drinks", "Oh I'll pay for dinner", Oh this is a date", "Oh dildos in your drawer." Like I'll give you head in exchange for a bottle of wine, type shit.

JAKE

Woah, okay. Look, I'm sorry I paid for dinner at McDonald's, okay? ...Where I come from, that's called being chivalrous.

KEHLANI

Bringing it up again and again doesn't feel very gentlemanly to me. It makes me feel like I owe you something.

JAKE

Look, I don't think that at all. I think you're cool, okay? You don't owe me anything. I paid, because I wanted to. Okay?

KEHLANI

Okay.

JAKE

Okay! And I'm sorry about those jokes. That was dumb.

KEHLANI

Thank you. I'm sorry for getting all animated...

They sip their wine, both finishing their glass. Kehlani gestures to the bottle, offering more. Jake nods, averting his eyes as he hands her his glass to refill.

JAKE

So... You don't ...wanna get with me?

KEHLANI

"Get with me?" Of course I do! I'm just saying that's not the reason I invited you over. What are you still going on about?

JAKE

Okay, cool... I just want to make sure we're both attracted to each other and you're not friend-zoning me...

He's firm but fragile. She sees this.

KEHLANI

Yeah.

They sip their wine. Kehlani looks over at Jake. She places her glass down on the table and shifts closer to him

KEHLANI (CONT'D)

So...

JAKE

So...

Jake leans in, hesitantly. Kehlani smiles, kissing him. He pulls away gently, still holding her close.

JAKE (CONT'D)

So it's okay if we-

KEHLANI

Shit, you're really fuckin up the vibes here.

JAKE

Hey! I gotta be sure. Can you blame me?

Jake laughs, they fall back onto the bed. Jake moves one hand up her arm, touching her neck. She freezes. She's suddenly in another space, another time, a different hand relating the same action Jake has just made. She tries to pull away, Jake moves his hand to the back of her neck, pulling her closer, not rough, but definitely firm. Kehlani sits up abruptly. Almost gasping, her hand races to the back of her neck. Jake sits up, confused.

JAKE (CONT'D)

Hey, What's happ-

KEHLANI

Why do you keep doing that?

JAKE

What?

KEHLANI

That thing, with your hand. You keep like, grabbing my neck and stuff. Is that meant to be hot or something?

Jake is taken aback. He reaches out to place a hand on Kehlani's thigh, she visibly tenses, he recoils instantly.

JAKE

I'm sorry. I- I didn't realize I was doing it.

KEHLANI

Well... you are.

JAKE

Okay... // I won't do it again. Sorry.

KEHLANI

// You don't have to keep apologizing, I just don't like it when people touch my neck and stuff. Okay?

JAKE

Okay, I won't do it again. Promise.

KEHLANI

Thanks

They sit silently on the bed, Jake leans over, going in for a kiss. Kehlani stands

KEHLANI (CONT'D)

I'm just... I'm just gonna go to the bathroom for a sec, I'll be back.

She leaves out the bathroom door. We hear the lock click. Jake sits on the edge of the bed. Confused. He looks to the bathroom door, we hear water running from the inside.

CUT TO:

4. INT. BATHROOM. NIGHT

Kehlani splashes water on her face. She breathes deeply. Looking at herself in the mirror, she regains herself. She sits on the edge of the bathtub, closing her eyes, she breathes deeply in through her nose, and out through her mouth.

CUT TO:

5. INT. KEHLANI'S APPARTMENT. NIGHT

Jake's eyes land on the journal on the coffee table. Glancing at the bathroom door where water is still running, he tiptoes over and picks up the journal. Jake reads.

CUT TO:

6. INT. BATHROOM. NIGHT

Kehlani is continuing her breathing pattern, centering herself. She opens her eyes, fixing her gaze steady back at herself. She straightens up, fixes her hair and gently dabs under her eyes. She turns away from the mirror, seeming stronger, more sure of herself.

CUT TO:

7. INT. KEHLANI'S APPARTMENT. NIGHT

Jake is flipping through the pages of Kehlani notebook. He appears to be idly reading until something catches his attention. He pauses, reading the page. The water stops running. Jake hurriedly places the notebook back and sits on the edge of the bed, trying his best to appear casual.

JAKE

Hey...

KEHLANI

Hey.

JAKE

Look, about before I-

KEHLANI

It's fine. I think I'm just tired or something.

JAKE

I can head off // if you want

KEHLANI

// No no, don't. It's okay

JAKE

You sure?

KEHLANI

What? And stay in your shitty motel room? Please.

Kehlani offers him a smile, letting him know it's okay.

JAKE

I mean... I wouldn't say no to staying... The Super8 carpet kinda smells.

KEHLANI

You like the wine, huh?

JAKE

I like you. I'd love to stay, only if you're sure though. No funny stuff.

Kehlani nods

JAKE (CONT'D)

And we don't have to like... do anything.

KEHLANI

Just Talk?

JAKE

Yeah... Talking's fine. Talking's great.

There's a slight disappointment in his tone. Kehlani doesn't miss this.

KEHLANI

Cool... well... you can sleep on the bed, if you like, or I've got like, a futon situation if you'd rather that. Or I can go on the futon, and you can have the bed to yourself. Or, I can-

JAKE

Futon sounds great.

KEHLANI

I'll set it up.

Kehlani goes about setting up the futon, pulling it out from under her bed and chucking a few pillows there, along with a throw blanket. Jake awkwardly sits down on it.

JAKE

Niiiiiiiice

KEHLANI

Do you want another blanket or anything?

JAKE

Nah, I'm fine.

The two look at each other for a moment

JAKE (CONT'D)

Cool... uh... so, we head to bed, then?

KEHLANI

Yeah, I guess so.

JAKE

Yeah. Yeah for sure

Kehlani climbs in bed. Jake lies down on his futon, their heads face the same direction. Its like there sleeping right next to each other but on two separate beds.

Kehlani reaches her hand down, feeling around for Jake's, he takes her hand in his.

KEHLANI

Thanks... for staying. I like having someone here... just..in case... you know?

JAKE

In case of what?

KEHLANI

Just... in case

He likes that

JAKE

It's cool. I'm here if you need me.

KEHLANI

I'm sorry I was weird before I just... yeah.

JAKE

It's fine. I mean, we don't really know each other, if you think about it.

KEHLANI

I feel like I know you. I mean, it feels like I do...

Jake gives her hand a gentle squeeze.

A moment.

KEHLANI (CONT'D)

You can come up to the bed... if you want.

Jake smiles and makes no hesitation. He climbs up into the bed with Kehlani. They look at each other.

KEHLANI (CONT'D)

Don't look at me like that!

JAKE

I'm just looking at you!

KEHLANI

You're looking at me like you feel sorry for me!

JAKE
I'm looking at you cause you're
pretty!

Kehlani shifts closer to him, allowing him to wrap his arms around her.

KEHLANI
You're gonna be here in the
morning, right?

JAKE
Where else would I go?

KEHLANI
And... you're not gonna-

JAKE
Not gonna what?

KEHLANI
Nothing. Don't worry about it.

Jake frowns, then nods slightly. Kehlani curls herself into him, falling asleep.

CUT TO:

8. INT. KEHLANI'S APPARTMENT. DAY

Jake still has his arm around Kehlani. She is nearly upside down- a chaotic sleeper. Slowly, she blinks her eyes open. She looks up at Jake, registering his arm. She lays here for a few seconds, just looking at him.

Jake stirs. Kehlani closes her eyes, pretending to be asleep. Jake moves, still asleep. He doesn't loosen his grip over Kehlani.

Kehlani opens her eyes again. She gently eases herself out of Jake's arms, lifting herself up out of the bed, careful not to wake him. She puts on a pair of jeans and a singlet top and throws her hair up into a loose bun. She grabs her shoes and takes a quick glance back at Jake before shutting the door to her apartment, leaving him there asleep.

CUT TO:

9. MOMENTS LATER

Jake wakes up in bed. He looks beside him, noticing Kehlani is gone.

JAKE

Kehlani?

No reply. He sits up, swinging his legs off the bed and standing up, he walks to the kitchen in his boxers.

JAKE (CONT'D)

Kehlani?

He continues to look for her around the apartment before finally accepting she's gone. He walks back to the bedroom, slumping down on the bed, he checks his phone. A missed call from MATT lights up the screen.

Jake dials Matt's number, places him on speaker.

JAKE (CONT'D)

Matt! Hey man!

MATT (V.O.)

Hey Jake, my boy! How's LA treatin ya?

JAKE

Not bad, not bad at all.

MATT (V.O.)

Rich and famous yet?

JAKE

Getting there

MATT (V.O.)

You left the the party early...
Meet any cute girls?

He smiles

JAKE

Just one

MATT (V.O.)

Atta boy!

JAKE

Yeah, I'm staying at her place...
right now, actually.

MATT (V.O.)

Hahaha, My man! Two in the pink,
one in the stink?

JAKE

Nah, nah its not like that. I'm just staying here.

MATT (V.O.)

You're staying at a chick's place and you're not drowning in pussy juice? You're lying.

JAKE

Truth. Just staying here, no... no juice involved.

Jake doesn't move his eyes from his phone.

MATT (V.O.)

What? She's lesbian or something?

Jake takes him off speaker phone and walks over to the desk.

JAKE

Not that I'm aware

MATT (V.O.)

Are you a lesbo? Or gay or whatever the hell it is for dudes?

JAKE

No. Shut up

He pauses

JAKE (CONT'D)

Like I said, I'm just sleeping here. It's not like that. She's-

CUT TO:

10. EXT. PARK. DAY

Kehlani is standing in the park. She looks up and see's KAYLEE (23, LA Party girl / influencer, the ultimate Nepo Baby) approaching her.

KAYLEE

Hey girl, are you ready to go? I need to get my steps up before this afternoon or Harley will kill me. He told me if I don't average at least 10,000 per day I'm not allowed to go over to Gwentyths for dinner anymore and that would just ruin my Goop collab.

KEHLANI

Yeah, I'm ready-

KAYLEE

Oh my god wait! Gigi! I need to walk her

KEHLANI

Who?

KAYLEE

Gigi! My dog!

KEHLANI

You have a dog?

KAYLEE

Yes, well, technically no. Pyro, KJs dog, just had puppies and she said I could totally have one but my Dad doesn't think i'm responsible enough to own a pet so I'm taking care of Gigi to show him that I'm super mature and I'd take such good care of a real dog.

KEHLANI

Real dog?

KAYLEE

Yeah. This is Gigi.

She pulls "Gigi", a stuffed toy dog out of her purse, holding it up close to her face and smiling

KAYLEE (CONT'D)

Say hi Gigi!

KEHLANI

... Hi Gigi...?

KAYLEE

I've already got a stylist lined up who's gonna take cover pictures of me for Douge. It's just like Vouge! But for dogs. Anyways, you never finished telling me about Nathans party last night. You left with someone? Spill. I want all the details, all the positions-

KEHLANI
We didn't sleep together

KAYLEE
What?

KEHLANI
Yeah... he seems different. Like...
he seemed to actually want to get
to know me.

KAYLEE
What, is he gay or something?

KEHLANI
I don't think so

KAYLEE
Then what's wrong with him? Is he
like... asexual? Or kind of you know...
retarded?

KEHLANI
No. He's just a guy

KAYLEE
A guy staying at your apartment. A
guy you don't know staying at your
apartment! What the fuck, Kehlani!
That's like, literally so
dangerous.

KEHLANI
Yeah, normally I'd agree with you
but, I don't know. I feel safe
around him. It's weird, I feel like
I can, just, be myself around him,
speak my mind. I told him I didn't
wanna have sex, and we didn't. And
he didn't push it. Like, he was
kinda weird about a few things-

KAYLEE
Right, so he's psycho

KEHLANI
No! He's genuinely nice!

KAYLEE
Kehlani, no guy is just "genuinely
nice". Trust me. What makes this
Jake guy so different?
(MORE)

KAYLEE (CONT'D)

Cause from what I'm hearing it kinda sounds like you're letting a homeless freak from Carmel, Indiana sleep in your bed, and that's not hot.

KEHLANI

He's not a freak, and he's not homeless.

KAYLEE

You seriously don't see how this is-

CUT TO:

11. KEHLANI'S APPARTMENT. DAY

Jake in Kehlani's APARTMENT, still on the phone to Matt, back on speaker. He is pacing around the apartment

MATT (V.O.)

Weird? Like, what kind of girl-

CUT TO:

12. INT. KEHLANI'S OFFICE. DAY

KAYLEE

- Takes in a random guy of the street?

KEHLANI

I told you it's not-

CUT TO:

13. INT. KEHLANI'S APPARTMENT. DAY

JAKE

- Like that! She's cool! She's like an artist or painter or works with water colors or whatever, and I like spending time with her. She's super smart and-

MATT (V.O.)

Sounds serious!

JAKE

I don't know man, I've only known her-

CUT TO:

14. INT. KEHLANI'S OFFICE. DAY

KEHLANI

- a day, and nothing bad's happened. I've got good instincts, Kaylee. Trust me. And he'll be gone by the time I get back!

KAYLEE

You're literally insane and I love it. Ugh. You're like, so weird. But like, what if he's still there?

KEHLANI

He won't be. He's a guy. They never stay.

KAYLEE

I know that's right... is he cute though?

KEHLANI

Yeah. Very

KAYLEE

And he plays guitar? That's so hot... he didn't like, make you listen to him sing or anything though right? That's like, the biggest ick of all time. I can not TELL you how musicians I've dated who've just forced me to sit there listening to them play. It's sooooo gross! Like what do you want me to do? Clap? Yuck. Like, put those fingers to better use you know what I mean?

KEHLANI

He didn't sing for me, no

KAYLEE

Lucky. Oh my god... all things aside this is such a great love story.

(MORE)

KAYLEE (CONT'D)

Girl takes in clueless guy, teaches him the ways of the world, opening him up to possibilities he never even dreamed of! Its like Aladdin in reverse. And he like... just talked to you? About stuff? And he was fine with not doing anything?

KEHLANI

Yeah

KAYLEE

Oh my god that's literal perfection. I can't remember the last time I went on a date and the guy didn't practically undress me in the restaurant. Except for that one time I went on a date with that married guy from SugarDaddies.com and then his wife showed up and it was this whole scene and I just had to sit there awkwardly while they fought. But if she hadn't shown up I SWEAR TO GOD he would've been tearing my dress off with his teeth right there at the table. Married guys are the worst.

Kehlani stares blankly at Kaylee.

KEHLANI

Jake sounds great though!

CUT TO:

15. INT. KEHLANI'S APPARTMENT. DAY

MATT (V.O.)

So, Where is she now?

JAKE

I don't know I woke up and she was gone

MATT (V.O.)

So you going through her shit or what?

JAKE

Nah man, she said not to

MATT (V.O.)

She's not there! What she doesn't know won't kill her. Don't be a puss! I'm telling you man, we gotta protect ourselves, man. One wrong move and she'll be accusing you of rape. You gotta get some dirt on her just in case you gotta use it later, then get the hell out of there and actually get laid or something.

JAKE

You're crazy, man. It's all good-

MATT (V.O.)

Yeahhh. Get your shit together, Jake. Call me when you do.

Jake hangs up the phone, exasperated. He looks around the room. He walks to Kehllani's bedside table, opening the top drawer just slightly before slamming it shut. He sits back down on the bed. Trying to restrain himself. Jake fidgets for a moment before opening it again, pulling out random objects, notebooks, pens, old photographs of Kehllani. He flicks through the photos before turning his attention to the notebooks.

16. INT. KEHLANI'S APPARTMENT. NIGHT

Kehllani returns from work, opening the door, she sees Jake sitting on the bed. She's shocked.

KEHLANI

Hey...

JAKE

Hey! You're back!

KEHLANI

You're... still here.

JAKE

Uhhh... yeah. Yeah, I'm still here. That's fine, yeah?

KEHLANI

I thought you'd have left by now. Snuck out or whatever, not...

She gestures to the room

KEHLANI (CONT'D)

Here

Jake shrugs

JAKE

I can go, I just thought you wanted me here.

KEHLANI

I do, I just didn't expect you to actually... be here.

JAKE

You asked me-

KEHLANI

I know, I asked you to stay. But no one actually stays. They say they will but-

JAKE

I wanted to see you again

KEHLANI

Okay...

JAKE

I mean, we had a good time last night, right? You had a good time?

KEHLANI

Yeah, last night was fun.

JAKE

So I just thought... Why end it there? I'd feel like an asshole if I slept with a girl and then didn't-

KEHLANI

What do you mean?

JAKE

You know...

KEHLANI

Oh my god. Did we- I don't even remember. How much did I have to drink? But I said- I remember saying I didn't wanna have sex! I said that. We didn't, right? I mean I would know if we had, I mean-

JAKE

No. It's okay, we didn't have sex.
We shared the bed... you told me to
come up to the-

KEHLANI

I remember that.

JAKE

But we didn't actually do anything.

Kehlani nods, relaxing down onto the bed again.

KEHLANI

So you're here to just...

JAKE

You asked me to stay

Jake shrugs. Kehlani is suspicious.

KEHLANI

Why are you acting like this?

JAKE

Huh?

KEHLANI

You. Being here. It's... weird. You
spent the whole day here? Just in
my place? (She looks around.)
Alone?

Kehlani is suddenly nervous. Her mind races.

KEHLANI (CONT'D)

Why are you here?

JAKE

Why shouldn't I be?

KEHLANI

You don't live here, for one! This
is my place! Second, I don't know
you! And third... because it's not
how things work!

Jake takes a breath, He'd steady

JAKE

Okay, How's it supposed to go?

KEHLANI

You get irritated that I didn't put out. You sneak off in the middle of the night and I wake up alone, wondering if you're just in the shower or something before realizing you're not coming back. Then I'll regret not fucking you because if I'd just fucked you maybe you'd still be here, and then I'll realize even if I had, you probably would've left anyway, because that's how it goes. The guy always leaves, whether he gets what he wants or not. That's how it's supposed to happen.

JAKE

That sounds... pretty shitty

KEHLANI

Well, yeah. It is. But that's life

JAKE

Sorry, I'm not that kinda guy-

KEHLANI

So you're not like other guys, I get it. Can we drop the performative male bullshit? What do you want? You want money?

Jake laughs. Shakes his head.

KEHLANI (CONT'D)

You want like... drugs or something? You an addict? Cause I don't have any-

JAKE

No.

She's frantic now, moving about her apartment.

KEHLANI

Then what? You wanna- you wanna have sex with me? You spent the whole day waiting for me to get back so you could fuck me? Cause that is SERIOUSLY not okay. And illegal. And I'll call 911.

JAKE

What in the world, no. I just wanted to see you again! I thought you would like that! I thought you wanted me to. I wanted to wait for you to get back-

KEHLANI

Well it's not cool. It's fucking weird. It's sexual harassment, ok?!

JAKE

It is *not*!

KEHLANI

Yes, it is!

JAKE

How? I haven't touched you!

KEHLANI

Just, cause.

JAKE

Cause I'm a man? Cause that's all I'm supposed to think about?

KEHLANI

Yeah. Pretty much

JAKE

And if it isn't

KEHLANI

Then... I don't know. You just want a place to stay. Like, I'm a fucking innkeeper // or something!

JAKE

// That's not-

KEHLANI

Save it, Jake! Just be honest. You don't wanna spend money on a motel so you're using me for a place to sleep. Fuck you-

JAKE

Oh my God! What is WITH you?

KEHLANI

No! That's not-

JAKE

How it works. I know. You've said. Jesus Christ. Can't a man do anything without having ulterior motives? My god! Like, society has made us out to be so villainous that even doing small things, like spending the night after being asked to stay, is deemed wrong. It's exhausting, having to tiptoe around, worrying that my every move is gonna be mistaken for flirting or assault.

KEHLANI

This is ridiculous! Can you hear yourself right now? You're scared about coming off as a "Bad Guy" meanwhile, women actually have to worry about meeting one!

JAKE

See what I mean? Ya'll are so scared to quite frankly, date, that when you do meet someone who's actually genuine, you make him feel like shit by automatically assuming he's got bad intentions.

KEHLANI

I bet thats really difficult for you.

JAKE

It is, actually. It makes dating really hard! Like, I walk a girl home, for example. On one hand, I'm making sure she gets home safe, but on the other she's like "Oh my god, he wants to know where I live" So I don't walk her home, now I'm the asshole cause I didn't care about her safety. Or I wait around to see a girl again, a girl I thought was super cool, thinking she'll be excited to see me and instead she accuses me of sexual harassment. Dammit, man. Matt was right.

KEHLANI

Who's Matt? Is someone else here-

JAKE

No!

KEHLANI

You're deranged. Fuck me!

JAKE

Hey! You're the one who asked me to-

KEHLANI

Stay! I know! I asked you to stay-
you keep reminding me! But now
you're... you're here! What do I do
with that! Like... Why are you here,
Jake? Please just tell me! What do
you want from me!

Jake looks at Kehlani, scared in the doorway. Inhaling deeply, placing his hands together diplomatically.

JAKE

Okay, here's a concept. A guy who
is not a complete asshole. Want's
to... get to know you. Just... talk.

KEHLANI

Just talk?

JAKE

Is that so crazy?

KEHLANI

Kinda, yeah.

JAKE

Well, not to me

Kehlani stands rigid. Jake stands, she flinches back, her body tense, ready to defend herself at any moment

KEHLANI

Stop

Jake is cautious, nervous, overwhelmed.

JAKE

Look. Kehlani, I promise, I'm not
up to anything, okay? You asked me
to stay, I stayed. I wanted to see
you again, get to know you. We had
a good time last night, I know I
did. So I thought "Hey.

(MORE)

JAKE (CONT'D)

I'm in LA, I don't know anyone here, I've met a cool girl, let's see where this goes.

KEHLANI

I dont know what "This" is.

JAKE

Neither do I. But I thought it was worth exploring. And I think you do, too.

KEHLANI

What makes you say that?

JAKE

You haven't called the cops yet... Or kicked me out.

KEHLANI

... I still could

JAKE

Yeah, you still could, yeah. But you haven't. Yet. So you must be a little curious, ...just a little bit..

Jake moves toward her but maintains a gap.

JAKE (CONT'D)

I'm not gonna hurt you. I promise.

Kehlani is motionless

JAKE (CONT'D)

I can go-

KEHLANI

You can stay

JAKE

... are you sure?

KEHLANI

It's fine... you can stay. Again. I guess. IF you admit that waiting here all day was weird and creepy.

JAKE

If you admit that you had a good time last night and you want to spend more time together.

KEHLANI

You go first, I asked you first.

They stare at each other. Then a moment.

JAKE

Waiting here all day was weird and creepy and I'm sorry. And if at any point you want me to leave-

KEHLANI

You can stay. I had a good time with you last night and... I'm glad you stayed... I think.

JAKE

Okay. Thanks

KEHLANI

You're welcome

They stand there, awkwardly. Neither one is sure how to break the ice.

KEHLANI (CONT'D)

Okay... okay. So, um- have you eaten? Do you want food or something then? I've got... bread and a toaster, or there's In & Out down the road, if you want-

Jake grins

JAKE

Toast sounds great.

CUT TO:

17. INT. KITCHEN. NIGHT

Kehlani takes the toast out of the toaster. She opens the fridge and pulls out butter and jam.

KEHLANI

Jam okay? It's raspberry.

JAKE

Sounds good.

She spreads jam onto the toast, handing the plate to him. She enjoyed making it for him.

KEHLANI

Here

She places the plate on the table before retreating back to the other side of the kitchen. He likes being served.

JAKE

Thanks

KEHLANI

So...

JAKE

Where'd you go this morning?

KEHLANI

Work.

JAKE

Oh. How was it?

She shrugs

KEHLANI

It was fine. Nothing special. Told my friend I had a guy stay over last night, she thought you were crazy and homeless.

JAKE

Ouch

Beat

JAKE (CONT'D)

Are you sure it's okay? Me being here?

KEHLANI

Yes. Look, I was just... I guess it freaked me out a little, I really wasn't expecting you to be here. And I don't know, I just assumed you wanted an easy lay. My bad, okay?

JAKE

Not everything has to be some big game...

KEHLANI

But it always is. In the end, that's all that it ever is.

JAKE
...I guess so

Jake shifts nervously. Kehlani softens

KEHLANI
Can we start fresh? Please... like
how it was before last night? like
before this morning? Just two
people, no bullshit, no past, no
baggage, just...

JAKE
I'd like that.

Beat.

JAKE (CONT'D)
So...

KEHLANI
So...

JAKE
Ummmm-

KEHLANI
Lets go out

JAKE
What, // like now?

KEHLANI
//Yeah. Like now. Let's get out of
here. Change up the energy.

JAKE
Okay? Where are we going?

KEHLANI
Cafe Mak

JAKE
Who?

KEHLANI
It's a restaurant. Well,
restaurants probably being
generous, actually. It's kinda
shitty. Like, a really shitty cafe.
But they have the best Sweet Potato
cake in the city, and there's never
anyone there.

JAKE
Sweet Potato cake?

KEHLANI
Trust me.

CUT TO:

18. INT. CAFE MAK. NIGHT

Cafe Mak IS shitty. Jake and Kehlani are the only people there. The menus are coated in sticky plastic, a bored waitress leans against the counter. The overhead light flickers every once in a while. Jake looks around, questioning the place..

JAKE
This where you bring all your
dates?

KEHLANI
Just you

JAKE
Lucky me

KEHLANI
And again, just like the last time.
Not a date.

JAKE
Can we pretend?

KEHLANI
Pretend?

JAKE
Yeah. Just act like we're a couple.

A moment

KEHLANI
Why? That's so fucking weird

JAKE
Only if you make it weird

Beat

KEHLANI
Can we be a couple in the middle of
a break up?

JAKE

Sure

KEHLANI

Okay, cool!

The waitress approaches, pen and paper in hand, ready to take their order.

KEHLANI (CONT'D)

Fuck you!

JAKE

Oh whats your issue now?

KEHLANI

My issue? You bring me to fucking
CAFE MAK on our 3 year anniversary?
// What's wrong with you!

JAKE

// You're the one who keeps going
on about how great the Sweet Potato
// cakes are!

KEHLANI

// I mentioned that ONE time!

WAITRESS

Should I give you guys a bit more
time... or-

KEHLANI

No. We're fine. We'll have the
Sweet Potato cake, thanks. Since
I'm fucking obsessed with them.

The waitress nods, then walks away. Kehlani and Jake laugh.

KEHLANI (CONT'D)

Okay, yeah, That was kinda fun.

JAKE

I feel kinda bad for her

KEHLANI

The waitress? I'm sure she gets a
lot crazier people, this is LA.

The waitress returns with the cake.

WAITRESS

Enjoy, guys. Lemme know if I can
get ya anything else.

KEHLANI

See? She's fine

Kehlani takes a spoon and grabs a bite.

KEHLANI (CONT'D)

So, what else do fake couples do on
fake dates?

JAKE

Probably what real couples do on
real dates?

Kehlani is silent. She chews..

JAKE (CONT'D)

What, am I your first date or
something?

KEHLANI

No. I just don't want to confuse
this for a REAL date. We need like,
ground rules

JAKE

Such as?

KEHLANI

Such as... We split the bill

JAKE

Okay

KEHLANI

And... no compliments

JAKE

Okay. Anything else?

KEHLANI

Thats all

JAKE

Okay... tell me something, then

KEHLANI

Like what

JAKE

Like, anything. I mean we're here,
on this date

KEHLANI

Fake date

JAKE

Fake date, so tell me something
about yourself. Where in Chicago
did you grow up, what's your
favorite color, how many people
have you been with before? Classic
first date questions.

KEHLANI

A suburb of Chicago, yellow, why
does it matter?

JAKE

It doesn't. It's just conversation

KEHLANI

You ask all your first dates those
questions?

JAKE

Just the fake ones

KEHLANI

I'm not telling you that

JAKE

Okay. Up to you

KEHLANI

How many girls have you been with?

JAKE

I asked you first

KEHLANI

And?

JAKE

Enough

KEHLANI

That's not a real answer.

JAKE

More than you gave

KEHLANI

Fine

JAKE

What if we wrote it down? ...and show each other at the same time?

KEHLANI

I'm not doing that elementary school bullshit. Why do you care so much?

JAKE

Just curious.

KEHLANI

I'm not talking about this

JAKE

You're the one who keeps bringing it up

KEHLANI

I never brought it up! You asked me how many guys I'd slept with.

JAKE

Not slept with, been with. Its different.

KEHLANI

Different how?

JAKE

I don't know! It just is!

KEHLANI

I'm not gonna let you reduce me to a number. Regardless of how you're defining it

JAKE

Fine. Let's just... talk about something else.

KEHLANI

Thank you

Silence

KEHLANI (CONT'D)

JAKE
10

KEHLANI
10?

JAKE
Yes. I didn't stutter

She likes the bite

KEHLANI
You know what, I'm not sure I can
even count all of my 9. It's more
like 7, realistically.

JAKE
Realistically it's 9. You can't not
count someone.

KEHLANI
Why not? They were bad decisions. I
don't have to count them if I don't
want to.

JAKE
"Bad decisions" are still
decisions. Whether you like 'em or
not. They count.

KEHLANI
What happened to "It's a concept!"

JAKE
That doesn't make any sense!

KEHLANI
That's literally what you said,
just taking your theory.

JAKE
You're twisting my words. I would
never say that.

KEHLANI
You did, though! Like 5 minutes
ago!

JAKE
Even if I did say that, that's not
the point I was making.

KEHLANI

Well, That's how I'm interpreting it.

JAKE

You can't just... make things up like that!

KEHLANI

Why not, you did.

JAKE

I- I guess, I did. Yeah.

KEHLANI

You did.

JAKE

I can see why we're breaking up

KEHLANI

We just don't work anymore

JAKE

I'm sorry I brought you to Cafe Mak on our anniversary.

KEHLANI

I will never forgive you.

Silence

KEHLANI (CONT'D)

So... now that we're officially broken up... who comes after me?

JAKE

Someone... reminiscent...

KEHLANI

Of me?

Jake shrugs. The waitress comes over and clears the table.

JAKE

And you? Who comes after me?

KEHLANI

Someone reminiscent...

JAKE

Of me?

KEHLANI
Of who I want you to be.

JAKE
And whats that?

KEHLANI
That's for me to know

JAKE
Any chance I can find out?

Kehlani Leans back in her chair

KEHLANI
We'll see.

CUT TO:

19. EXT. STREET. NIGHT.

Kehlani and Jake walk together

JAKE
I'm getting serious De Ja Vu night
now.

KEHLANI
Of what?

JAKE
Last night. Walking back to yours.

KEHLANI
That's not De Ja Vu, that's just a
memory.

JAKE
What's De Ja Vu, then?

KEHLANI
Remembering something that's never
happened before, but you feel like
it has.

JAKE
Oh... so, when you feel like you've
met someone before but you never
have?

KEHLANI
Yeah, Kinda.

JAKE

Like how you were saying last night
"I feel like I know you."

KEHLANI

I guess so.. I said that?

JAKE

Something like that.

They reach Kehlani's apartment. She fishes for the keys in her bag then unlocks the door.

JAKE (CONT'D)

So, if that was a real date... this
is where we'd say goodbye.

KEHLANI

And how would you do that?

They stand in the doorway.

JAKE

Well... I'd probably put my hands
here.

He puts his hands on her waist. Smiles.

JAKE (CONT'D)

And I'd thank you for a lovely
night, for going on a date with me,
for splitting the bill...

She laughs.

JAKE (CONT'D)

And then I'd probably... give you a
kiss goodnight.

KEHLANI

Oh, you would, would you?

JAKE

Probably yeah. If it was a real
date.

KEHLANI

But it's not.

JAKE

Yeah.

They stay standing in the doorway. Their faces are so close to one another.

JAKE (CONT'D)

And then... after that. I'd probably hope for an invite up.

KEHLANI

Is that so?

JAKE

Yeah.

KEHLANI

Well.. Jake, would you like to come up?

JAKE

I'd love to.

CUT TO:

20. KEHLANI'S APPARTMENT. DAY

Jake and Kehlani wake up

KEHLANI

Morning

JAKE

You're still here

KEHLANI

So are you.

Jake smiles

KEHLANI (CONT'D)

Don't

JAKE

Don't what?

KEHLANI

Get used to it. This isn't real, remember? It's not real life. It's like a... dream or something.

JAKE

I don't know, I feel pretty awake

KEHLANI

You know what I mean. We're not...
this is just a moment. Soon you'll
go back to your own life, I'll go
back to mine.

JAKE

What if we don't?

Kehlani smiles softly, a sadness behind her eyes.

JAKE (CONT'D)

Is that what you want?

KEHLANI

We don't make sense, Jake. And as
nice as this is, it's just not...
realistic.

JAKE

I hate realism.

Kehlani laughs, inching closer to Jake.

JAKE (CONT'D)

So I guess I'll just have to make
the most of this, huh?

KEHLANI

Mmhmmm

They two lay in bed, neither moving. Their breath moves in
time. Jake looks directly in front of him, Kehlani has her
gaze resting just beside her where she leans against Jake,
her eyes flicking up every so often to look at him.

JAKE

We don't have to, you know. Go our
separate ways. I mean we could stay
together. And I'm not saying that
to trap you. I'm just saying... we're
both attractive people-

KEHLANI

Mhmm

JAKE

We get along, for the most part. We
challenge each other... you challenge
me, at least. In a good way though,
like in a way that makes me a
better person. And I don't know. I
can't see any reason why we
wouldn't work.

(MORE)

JAKE (CONT'D)

You say it's not realistic but... I think I might be in lo- I think, I really like you. // Just a little bit.

Kehlani sits up suddenly

KEHLANI

// You don't even know me. You're not in love with me. Don't say that.

JAKE

I love the parts of you I do know. That much is true. But isn't that how it happens? You don't know someone. And then you get to know them over time and you find more and more reasons to stay in love with them? I mean, when I first saw you... I felt something. Like electricity across the room- you felt it, too. Don't deny it. You did.

KEHLANI

I... Yeah. Yeah, I did.

JAKE

Exactly! That doesn't happen every day, meeting someone and instantly feeling that, that they're meant to be a part of your life...

KEHLANI

I can't... rearrange my whole life just because you love the idea of me. This is crazy. // This is your dick talking!

JAKE

// Then let me love more than the idea of you. Let me stay. Let me be around.

KEHLANI

Jake. You're not making sense, where are you gonna live? Here? No. Three months will go by and you'll hate me. You'll resent me and then this 'magic' that we have will be gone.

(MORE)

KEHLANI (CONT'D)

And we'll both regret it and wonder why we couldn't just let things stay beautiful while they were. Just quit while we were ahead so we could always have this small moment in time to look back on and remember how great it was

JAKE

I don't think I could ever resent you-

KEHLANI

You'll get tired of me. You'll get to know me for real for real- and it'll happen. Trust me, I'm saving you the trouble.

JAKE

And if I want the trouble?

KEHLANI

Trust me, you don't

JAKE

You're good trouble

They sit in silence. There's nothing left to say, it's a stalemate.

KEHLANI

Coffee?

JAKE

Yeah...

Kehlani gets up out of bed, she throws her hair up into a messy bun and walks to the kitchen, Jake follows, slightly deflated. Kehlani goes about making the coffee, she leaves hers black with a dash of milk, pausing when she gets to Jake's mug.

KEHLANI

Cream?

JAKE

And sugar, thanks.

Kehlani nods, spooning sugar in his cup. Before handing it to him, their hands brush as he takes the mug off her.

JAKE (CONT'D)

Thanks

Kehlani nods. Taking a sip from her mug

JAKE (CONT'D)
So... who hurt you?

KEHLANI
Excuse me?

JAKE
What's got you so hurt that we
can't be together? C'mon, tell me.

KEHLANI
Jake, stop it.

JAKE
Oh come on! Be honest with me! I'm
asking you...

KEHLANI
I'm not- We're not doing this

JAKE
Fine. I'll go first-

KEHLANI
No. Don't tell me anything

JAKE
Lani-

KEHLANI
Jake! Please. Can we just... talk
about something else? Like...
anything?

JAKE
... I haven't washed any of my
clothes since I've been here. And
I'm hoping you might have a laundry
machine I can use?

KEHLANI
Yeah, course

JAKE
Thank god. I've been wearing the
same pair of socks for damn near
three days.

KEHLANI
Ew. What the helly, you only
bought one pair?

JAKE

I needed more space for other stuff, I thought one pair would last me for a while. And they did pretty well, to be honest...kinda liberating.

KEHLANI

To not wash your clothes?

JAKE

Yeah. Kinda manly

KEHLANI

Kinda disgusting

JAKE

Cavemen didn't wash their clothes.

KEHLANI

Cavemen didn't WEAR clothes, and we evolved for a reason.

JAKE

I'm just reconnecting with my roots, my people, the Vikings.

Kehlani roars with laughter

KEHLANI

Nothing that you're saying right now is sexy.

JAKE

I don't even need to talk to be hot.

KEHLANI

Okay so shut up then. Machine's down the hall. Grab your stuff. It's coin operated. So take your wallet.

Jake hesitates.

JAKE

It's just... down the hall?

KEHLANI

Yeah, down the hall to the left. It's a shared one.

JAKE

Oh.

Jake walks slowly to exit the kitchen.

JAKE (CONT'D)
And.. I'll need a wallet?

KEHLANI
Do you want me to come?

JAKE
Please?

Kehlani rolls her eyes.

CUT TO:

21. INT. LAUNDRY ROOM. DAY

Jake stands by the machine, looking lost.

KEHLANI
Are you for real, right now?

JAKE
I'm just gonna say it, I've never
done laundry.

KEHLANI
You can't do your own laundry?

JAKE
Just teach me, I'm a good student.

KEHLANI
I'm not doing it for you. Figure it
out. I'm not your Mom!

Jake takes it in stride. He tries to figure out the washing machine and is guided by Kehlani either making disapproving or approving sounds. He finally gets it. Kehlani sarcastically claps.

KEHLANI (CONT'D)
Well done. You should be proud.

JAKE
Thank you, thank you. I am. I
couldn't have done it without you.

KEHLANI
Should've known you were a mama's
boy.

JAKE
You know what-

KEHLANI
Can't do laundry. That's Mom's job.

JAKE
I love my Mom! What can I say?
That's not a bad thing!

KEHLANI
I didn't say it was a bad thing.

JAKE
She doesn't do everything for me,
come off it-

KEHLANI
I didn't necessarily say she did.

JAKE
You implied it. And besides, isn't
that like, a green flag? Guys being
close with their mothers?

KEHLANI
It can go either way. They're
either sweet guys, who just missed
out on a few basic life skills, or
they're the most obnoxious people
on earth.

They listen to the washing machine. They're really getting on.

JAKE
If you think about it, this is the
worst time to be a man.

KEHLANI
Ummm.

JAKE
Its true! I mean, think about it,
back in the 60's, all I'd have to
do is go out, work my job and bring
home some money. I'd come home to
my wife and kids and pot roast
every night! But now, because women
have careers outside the home, the
workload is more, you see?

KEHLANI
I'm not sure I follow.

JAKE

I'm expected to cook, clean, do laundry, all that stuff, as well as make the money.

KEHLANI

So am I, and that's just basic life skills-

JAKE

No but what I'm saying is there's more work involved for each person. Not only do both men and women have to be homemakers, we also both have to be bread winners.

KEHLANI

And that's bad because...? Because you don't know how to cook for yourself?

JAKE

Yes! No! Wait- I'm not saying it's a BAD thing, I'm just saying it would have been easier to be a man in the 60's. You're completely missing my point.

KEHLANI

I don't think I am.

JAKE

Well, you're being dramatic.

CUT TO:

22. INT. KEHLANI'S APPARTMENT. NIGHT

Jake and Kehlani sit on the bed, Jake holds a beer in his hand, Kehlani holds a wine.

KEHLANI

I don't know how you drink that stuff.

Jake takes a gulp.

JAKE

More you drink, better it tastes.

Kehlani rolls her eyes.

KEHLANI

Well, four cans in, it must be
tasting pretty good right about
now.

JAKE

Like orange juice.

Kehlani laughs.

JAKE (CONT'D)

Come on, try a sip.

KEHLANI

Ew, no.

JAKE

Come on! It's not so bad, and like
I said, the drunker you are, the
better it tastes!

KEHLANI

I'm just a little tipsy. Not drunk.

JAKE

One sip. For me?

Kehlani rolls her eyes, taking a sip from the can Jake's holding
out to her. She recoils, wincing at the taste.

KEHLANI

EW.

JAKE

Lani.

KEHLANI

Not my fault it tastes like battery
acid!

JAKE

Whatever, fancy girl. Want a top
up?

He gestures to her half-full glass. Kehlani shakes her head,
smirking.

KEHLANI

I've got a better idea...

JAKE

What?

Kehlani moves to her bedside table, opening the bottom drawer, she pulls out a small plastic bag filled with weed.

JAKE (CONT'D)

Is that-

KEHLANI

This is California, babe. Chill.
Everyone smokes weed.

JAKE

I don't know-

KEHLANI

Have you never smoked before?

Jake shakes his head.

JAKE

Does it make you paranoid?

Kehlani shrugs.

KEHLANI

Only if you let it. Just relax.

JAKE

I already feel paranoid.

KEHLANI

Babe.

JAKE

Hey!

KEHLANI

(Mocking him from earlier) Just one
hit? For me?

JAKE

Fine.

Kehlani assembles the bong, grabs a lighter. Taking a hit, she hands it to Jake, she coughs. Jake takes a hit, he coughs. Kehlani laughs.

JAKE (CONT'D)

I think I'm already feeling it.

KEHLANI

You are not!

JAKE

No. I am. I'm faded right now.

Kehlani roars.

KEHLANI

You've had one hit, my guy!

JAKE

Wow... my body feels so-yeah, I'm faded. Is this what it's like being high? ...Fuck, what if i get paranoid? I'm already so-

KEHLANI

Okay, babe. First rule of Fight Club. If you talk about being paranoid, you'll get paranoid. So let's just have fun, k?

JAKE

K.

Jake looks at Kehlani as she takes another hit.

JAKE (CONT'D)

You're kinda sexy when you smoke.

Kehlani laughs, handing it back to him. He takes a hit, trying not to cough again.

KEHLANI

And you're... cute when you smoke.

They giggle.

CUT TO:

MONTAGE SCENE

Jake and Kehlani move through the house, they dance, they laugh, they eat food. Kehlani puts lipstick on Jake. The two move through the world in a new way, things are fun, relaxed. They're free. Neither on worried about the past, present or future.

CUT TO:

KEHLANI

Can I ask you something?

JAKE

Shoot.

KEHLANI

Do you think it's... weird, that we're not sleeping together? Like, you've been staying here for a minute now, and the most we've done is kiss, that doesn't bother you?

JAKE

That's... a helluva question to ask me right now.

Kehlani shrugs.

JAKE (CONT'D)

Okay, well. No. I don't think it's weird. It's just two people who genuinely like each other, cohabitating and sharing a bed.

KEHLANI

That sounds weird when you say it like that.

JAKE

Okay, so maybe it is a little weird but I don't mind. I like being here with you.

KEHLANI

The first night you were here... you wanted to fuck me, though right?

JAKE

Yeah.

KEHLANI

Why didn't you... push?

JAKE

You weren't into it.

KEHLANI

And after that?

JAKE

What do you mean?

KEHLANI

Do you still, do you still wanna sleep with me?

JAKE

Yeah. Yeah I do. I was just... I don't know, just waiting for the right time.

She stares into his soul.

KEHLANI

...It's the right time.

JAKE

Huh?

KEHLANI

Did I stutter?

Jake leans over her, gently pushing her back onto the bed. They kiss. Kehlani gently pushes him off her.

KEHLANI (CONT'D)

One condition.

JAKE

There's always one condition with you!

KEHLANI

You can't take it back. Any of it.

Jake kisses her, moving closer.

JAKE

That's how sex works. You can't take it back.

KEHLANI

No. I mean before. Us. How we are. That can't change after. I want us to stay... nice. Like we are.

JAKE

I want that, too.

KEHLANI

So you promise?

JAKE

I promise.

Kehlani sits up slightly, kissing him back.

CUT TO:

Jake and Kehlani lie in bed. Kehlani has the covers strewn across her, Jake lies next to her, breathing heavily.

JAKE (CONT'D)

Did you...

KEHLANI

Yeah.

Silence.

KEHLANI (CONT'D)

And you-

JAKE

It's kinda harder to fake for a guy, you know? I mean it's pretty obvious I-

KEHLANI

Right. Yeah. Course.

They lie there for a few more beats. Kehlani moves closer to Jake, she's apprehensive, almost tense, but wants to be closer to him. Jake sits up, as if he's getting up out of bed.

JAKE

Well, thanks. That was fun!

KEHLANI

Are you serious?

JAKE

Uhhh, what?

KEHLANI

You're leaving?

JAKE

I mean, did you need me for something? You finished, right?

KEHLANI

Yeah-

JAKE

So? Why do I need to stick around, we're done here, right?

KEHLANI

Oh my god... OH my god!!!

JAKE

What?

KEHLANI

I can't believe this! After all that fucking talk about staying and wanting to know me... that was all just- what the fuck is your problem? What have the last three fucking days been to you, huh? Nothing? All just some big elaborate scheme to fuck me and then still leave? What in the Christ. That's evil. You're actually evil-

Jake starts laughing.

KEHLANI (CONT'D)

What? What about this is funny to you? I cant believe-

JAKE

I'm joking, I'm joking, I'm joking with you.

KEHLANI

You're-

JAKE

I'm joking!

KEHLANI

Oh. You're an asshole. Fuck you.

Jake lays back down, wrapping his arms around Kehlani.

JAKE

Hey.

KEHLANI

Fuck you. That wasn't funny.

JAKE

It was a little funny.

KEHLANI

Me getting upset is funny? //
Scaring me is funny?

JAKE:

// You're cute when you're mad.

KEHLANI

You're the most insufferable man on the planet, you know that?

JAKE
OOoo yeah, talk dirty to me.

KEHLANI
Just, stop talking, for one second,
please?

Jake laughs, pulling her in closer.

JAKE
Made you paranoid, didn't I? Must
be the weed.

KEHLANI
You're annoying.

JAKE
Hey.

KEHLANI
Mmm?

JAKE
Remember how I said I thought I was
falling in love with you?

KEHLANI
Mmmm. You didn't actually say it,
though-

JAKE
I did. I won't take it back. I mean
it, Lani.

Kehlani sighs, saying nothing. She nestles herself closer into him.

JAKE (CONT'D)
Kehlani?

Silence.

JAKE (CONT'D)
Kehlani!

Silence.

JAKE (CONT'D)
I just told you I'm falling in love
with you. Do you have anything to
say?

Silence.

JAKE (CONT'D)

Why do you do this?

KEHLANI

Do what?

JAKE

Bail on me every time I get real with you? Every time I try to... make something more of this. What else can I do?

KEHLANI

Nothing-

JAKE

I really like you, Lani. I do. But I don't know how much longer I can play this game for. It feels like you're using me.

KEHLANI

I'm not using you!

JAKE

Then what is it? You say this isn't realistic, that you'll hurt me. But not telling me anything is hurting me more.

KEHLANI

Okay.

JAKE

Please.

KEHLANI

I moved here when I was sixteen. That's the simple version.

Kehlani Shrugs. Jake gestures for her to continue

KEHLANI (CONT'D)

Home wasn't... great. My dad left when I was little, and my mom—she collected boyfriends. They'd move in, promise everything, then leave. They always left. It hurt her, it hurt me, but it hurt my siblings the most. I learned early that "love" is just something people say before they go.

She sighs.

KEHLANI (CONT'D)

Then there was this guy, Andy. He was loud. And mean. Maybe just empty. One night he smashed a window to get in and ended up in my room. And, I called for my mom, I thought she'd come. (Beat.) She was supposed to protect me. (Beat.) I could see her through the crack in the door. She didn't move. Didn't say anything. She just stood there. (Beat.) I left soon after. I never went back, never called. It's easier when you don't need anyone.

JAKE

I'm sorry that happened to you.

He puts his hand on the side of her face, comforting her

JAKE (CONT'D)

So, you don't need anyone?

KEHLANI

I don't.

Kehlani stares at him, earnestly. He stares back.

FADE TO BLACK.